from the obvious global jihadi influences and nor should it alter our perceptions of the overarching objectives. Rather it merely suggests the attacks were perhaps even more operationally successful than they were intended to be.

After Mumbai India quickly suspended the composite dialogue with Pakistan. Meanwhile, Lashkar experienced a boost in the influx of money and men.[112] Its popularity also surged on jihadi forums as a result of the group's target selection and operational sophistication. For example, the Al-Yaqeen Media Center issued a report assessing the gains achieved including striking a blow against the crusaders, 'creating a new crusader enemy' in an area with a large Muslim population and illustrating the mujahideen's power, intelligence and fighting abilities. It opined that because the operations were so successful they could contribute to copycat attacks.[113] Security and counter-terrorism officials in many Western countries also took note of this possibility, and began increasing their vigilance against this type of low-tech assault. The fear was not only that Mumbai might inspire other jihadis to prosecute such an attacks, but also that Lashkar might launch an assault in a Western country or train others to do so. The New York Police Department was concerned enough about the possibility of similar strikes in New York City that it sent three officers to Mumbai to study the attacks in detail in order to take the necessary precautions to prevent their repeat.[114] The fear of copycats was not unfounded, as subsequent fidayeen-style assaults in Afghanistan and Pakistan proved. Nor was the concern that Lashkar might attempt attacks outside of India, as the next chapter will detail. Indeed, the attacks not only marked Lashkar's return to the South Asian limelight, but also its emergence as a significant player in the global jihad.